TCS CORPORATE WEBSITE

Columns — Authoring Guide

Role / audience	Authoring — Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
Last validated	2026-11-08
Documents	1
Classification	INTERNAL — classification to be confirmed

Generated from the Markdown sources of docs/handover (branch migrated-page-content-edam); do not edit this PDF.

Contents

Columns — Authoring Guide
- Where to see it
- For Content Authors
- Authorable Fields
- Screenshot-Based Authoring Steps
- Variations
- Complete Authoring Example
- Content and Asset Guidelines
- Troubleshooting
- Screenshots
- Known limitations
- Open items
- Change history

Columns — Authoring Guide

Attribute	Value
Document ID	AUT-C-columns
Audience	Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Purpose	How to add, fill in and check the Columns component
Scope	—
Prerequisites	—
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
Approver	Product Owner (to be confirmed)
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Last updated	8 November 2026
Last validated	8 November 2026
Source files	blocks/columns/README.md, blocks/columns/_columns.json
Related documents	—
Related AEM paths	—

1. Where to see it

- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/columns
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/columns/columns-mobile-inset
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/columns/columns-variations

2. For Content Authors

Columns can no longer be added. To maintain an existing one:

1. Select the Columns block on the page; its properties show **Columns** and **Rows** (the grid size set when it was created).
2. Select a column to edit its content or to add a **Text**, **Image** or **Title** to it.
3. A button in a column is a link in a Text made bold (primary) or italic (secondary).
4. Preview, publish, and check the published page at mobile and desktop widths.

To replace it (recommended):

1. Add a **Columns Container** where sections are added (or, inside a Tabs Container tab, use Column Breaks after the Tab).
2. For each column of the Columns block, add a **Column Break**, then the column's content (Text, Title, Image; Button blocks for buttons).
3. Set **Columns per row** to the number of columns per row of the old block; Gap Medium, Vertical alignment Middle and Side by side from Desktop come closest to the old layout (the old block centred columns vertically with a 1.5rem gap from 900px).
4. Delete the Columns block, preview, publish.

3. Authorable Fields

Columns (`columns`)

Model `columns`.

Stored on a new component (definition template): `columns` = `"2"`, `rows` = `"1"`.

Content tab — Columns

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Columns	`columns`	text	No	`""`	—	—	—
Rows	`rows`	text	No	`""`	—	—	—

Notes on the fields:

- **Columns** and **Rows** (`columns`, `rows`): the size of the grid AEM creates for a new Columns (template values 2 and 1); the code reads the number of cells of the first row, not these values.
- **No Additional tab:** AEM delivers no `classes_*` for the built-in Columns component, so the dialog has none (removed in the block audit, handover 2.27). The motion decorator still lists `columns` (columns as staggered targets), but without delivered classes no animation can be authored.
- **Column content:** the `column` filter allows Text, Image and Title.
- **Data layer:** the block is a component `tcs-corp/components/columns`.

4. Screenshot-Based Authoring Steps

Authoring Step 1: Find the Columns to migrate

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
columns-authoring-step-1.png

Purpose:
An existing Columns block selected in the content tree, with its Columns and Rows properties.

Annotations:
A = Columns block in the tree
B = Columns
C = Rows
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
B	Columns	(read only) 2	Number of columns to recreate	—
C	Rows	(read only) 1	Number of rows	—

Author action: note the columns and their content. Common mistake: looking for Columns in the Add (+) list; it is no longer offered.

Authoring Step 2: Add the Columns Container

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
```

```
columns-authoring-step-2.png

Purpose:
A Columns Container added next to the old Columns block, with Columns per row 2.

Annotations:
A = Columns Container
B = Columns per row
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Add (+) on the page	Columns Container	Replacement	Empty container
B	Columns per row	2	As the old block	Two columns per row
—	Vertical alignment	Middle	The old block centred its columns	`align-middle`

Authoring Step 3: Recreate the columns

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
columns-authoring-step-3.png

Purpose:
Two Column Breaks with the moved content (Image, then Title and Text), and the old Columns block
deleted.

Annotations:
A = Column Break 1 and the Image
B = Column Break 2 and the Title and Text
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Column Break 1 content	Image (with alt text)	First column	Image column
B	Column Break 2 content	Title, Text, Button block	Second column	Text column

Author action: add the Column Breaks and content, delete the old block, preview at 390px and 1440px, publish. Business rule: the Columns Container stacks columns in their order (the old block moved image-only columns first on mobile): put the image column first if it should come first on mobile. Validation: the page looks as before at desktop width.

5. Variations

The variations below exist only in content authored before; the code renders them as follows.

Two columns

Two cells per row: equal columns side by side from 900px, stacked below.

Three or more columns

Any number of cells per row; each takes an equal share (`flex: 1`). The class `columns-{n}-cols` is added (n = cells of the first row) but no CSS uses it.

Image column

A cell whose only content is a picture gets `columns-img-col`: shown first when stacked (`order: 0`), image full width.

Multiple rows

Each row is its own flex row; rows don't share column widths beyond their equal shares.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
columns-image-column-mobile.png

Purpose:
An existing Columns block with an image-only column on the right at mobile width: the image shown above the text.

Annotations:
A = Image column moved first
B = Text column
```

6. Complete Authoring Example

Scenario: migrating a two-column "Cloud transformation" Columns (image left, heading, text and a button right) to a Columns Container.

Field	Example value	Guidance
Columns Container Columns per row	2	As the old block
Vertical alignment	Middle	As the old layout
Gap	Medium	Closest to the old 1.5rem gap
Column Break 1	Image (alt text "Cloud operations dashboard")	Keep the alt text
Column Break 2	Title "Cloud transformation, end to end", Text, Button block "Explore cloud services"	Button blocks replace bold links

Expected output: the same layout from 900px; stacked below in content order. Accessibility: alt text and heading order unchanged. Analytics: the component becomes `tcs-corp/components/columns-container`, its blocks its children. Personalization fallback: none.

Pre-publish checklist: all content moved; old block deleted; checked at mobile and desktop widths.

7. Content and Asset Guidelines

- Only Text, Image and Title in columns; buttons as bold (primary) or italic (secondary) links in a Text.
- Images: full column width (`width: 100%`); alt text on every meaningful image.
- Min / max: no verified technical limit was identified; many columns become narrow (equal shares, no wrapping).
- New content: use the Columns Container.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
Columns not in the Add (+) list	Deprecated, removed from the filters	—	Use a Columns Container	—
A block can't be added to a column	The `column` filter allows Text, Image, Title only	—	Migrate to a Columns Container	Block in a column
No spacing / anchor / hide options	No Additional tab for the built-in component	—	Migrate to a Columns Container	Options available
Image not first on mobile	The cell holds more than the picture	Inspect for `columns-img-col`	Keep the image alone in its cell, or migrate	Image first
Columns too narrow	Many cells per row (no wrapping)	Count the cells	Migrate with Columns per row	Columns wrap into rows

9. Screenshots

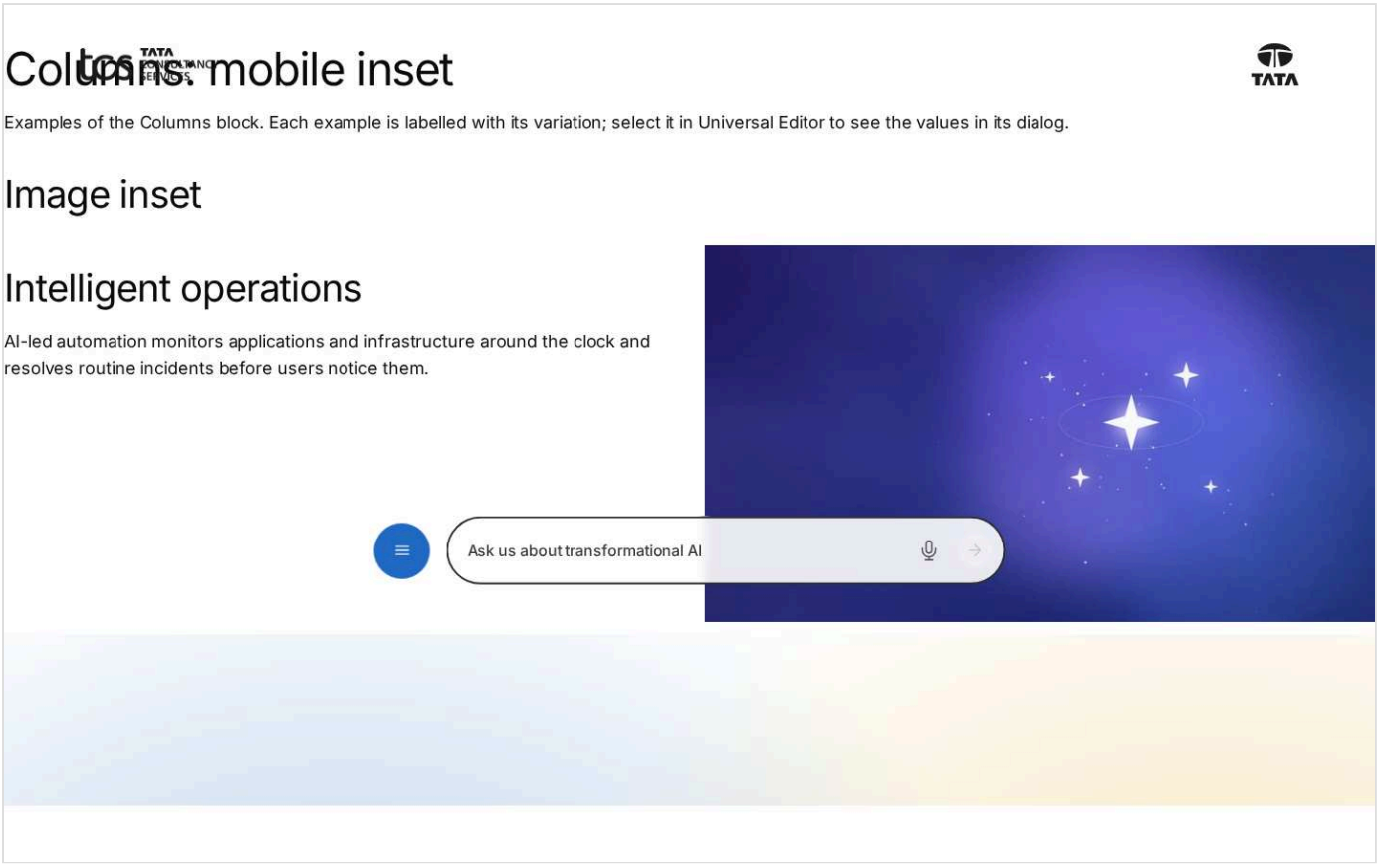


Figure: Columns as published (block library) — desktop 1440 × 900 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/columns/columns-mobile-inset, captured 2026-11-08).

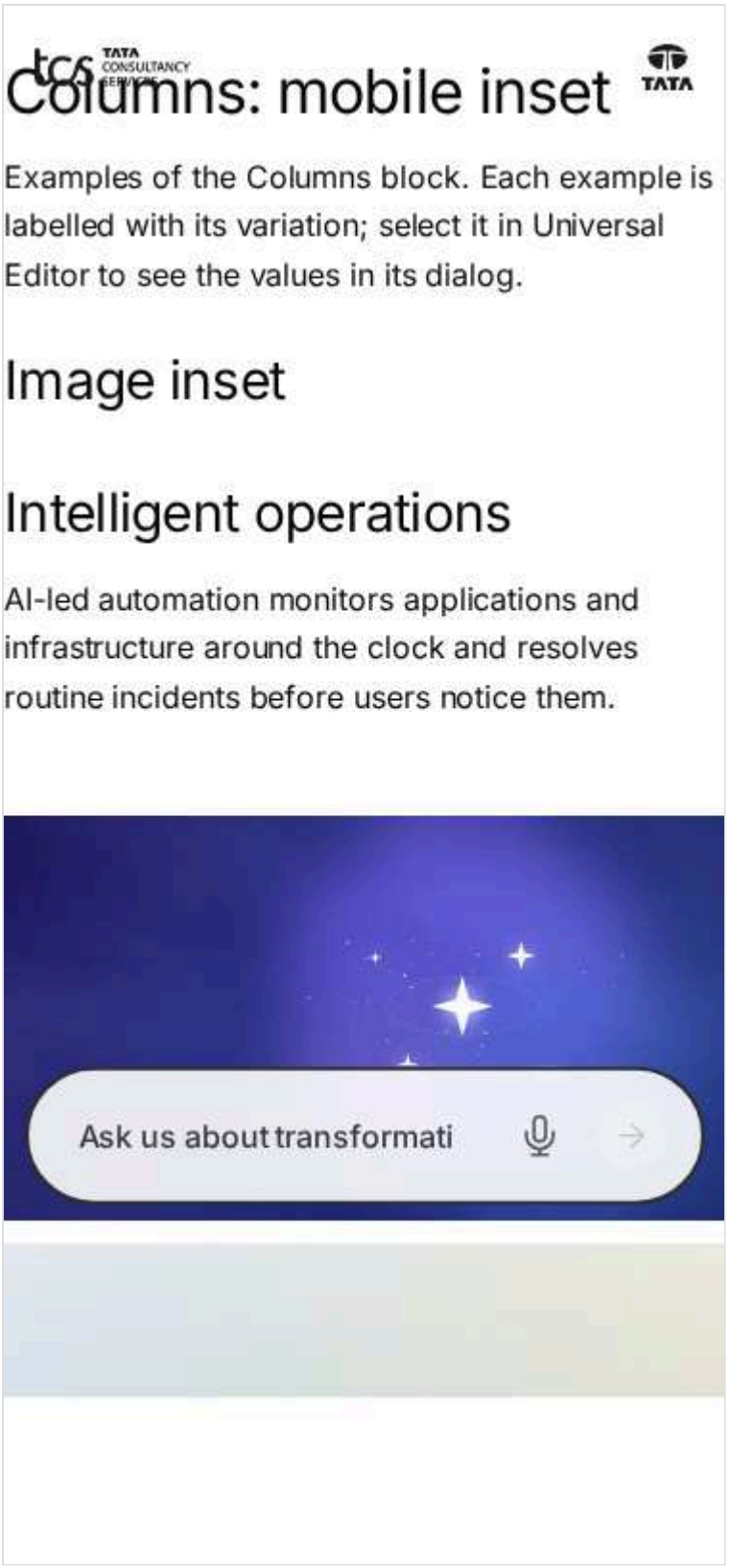


Figure: Columns as published (block library) — mobile 375 × 812 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/columns/columns-mobile-inset, captured 2026-11-08).

> **Screenshot required**
>
> - Required screen: Columns dialog in Universal Editor (every tab, including Additional)
> - Required role/access: AEM Sites author with Universal Editor (content author)

- Required navigation steps: AEM Sites console > /content/tcs-corp/language-masters/en > open a page in Universal Editor
- Reason unavailable: No AEM author access in the documentation program (access blocker AB-01)
- Owner: Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
- Target completion date: To be confirmed

10. Known limitations

- Universal Editor screenshots are placeholders: no author access in this program.

11. Open items

- None.

12. Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	8 November 2026	Delivery team (documentation program)	First version of the role-specific documentation (master documentation prompt), generated from the repository and the published reference pages